Guanqun Zhou

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Education

Nanyang Technological University, Nanyang Business School · *Research Fellow* Supervisor: Prof. Byoung-Hyoun Hwang	July 2026 – Present
University of Colorado Boulder, Boulder · *Ph.D. in Finance* Advisor: Prof. Diego García	2026
Nanjing University, Nanjing · *M.S. in Management Science and Engineering*	2018
Nanjing University, Nanjing · *B.S. in Financial Engineering*	2015

Research Interests

Corporate Finance; Innovation; Labor; AI & Financial Education

Research

Working Papers

New Neighbor, New Opportunities: The Impact of Neighborhood-Level Inventor Interactions

Presented at: CU Boulder Finance Brownbag (2024)

This study explores how neighborhood-level social interactions among inventors shape individual productivity, research direction, and career moves. Using a comprehensive dataset of inventor move-in events in California from 1990—2019 and a spatial difference-in-differences design that compares incumbent inventor residents located near versus far from the entrant, I find that the arrival of new inventor neighbor increases incumbents' subsequent patenting. This effect is stronger when the entering inventor is active and productive and when local social capital is higher. Entrants also reshape incumbents' research trajectories. Technological similarity increases the propensity to stay in the current field, whereas dissimilarity increases the propensity to enter new fields. Word-embedding analyses of patent text show that dissimilar pairs tilt toward the entrant's technology space, consistent with learning. At the career margin, treated inventors are more likely to stick with current employer when have similar entrants. These findings underscore the role of local inventor interactions in shaping the innovation ecosystem and provide micro-evidence on the mechanisms of knowledge spillovers and agglomeration.

Do Stock Repurchases Cause Harm? Evidence from Financially Distressed Firms, with David Ikenberry and Theo Vermaelen

Media coverage: Morgan Stanley Investment Management - Which One Is It? Equity Issuance and Retirement

Presented at: Division of Economic and Risk Analysis (DERA) U.S. Securities and Exchange Commission Academic Seminar Series (2025), Rice University(2025)*, University of North Texas(2025)*, Penn State(2025)*, FMA(2024)*, WFC(2024)*, EFMA(2024)*, INSEAD Finance Brownbag (2024)*, CU Boulder Finance Brownbag (2024).* (*co-author presented)

Critics offer numerous reasons for how buybacks cause harm. Crimping investment and innovation; perverting capital structures; and impairing employment are a few of the claims prompting U.S. legislators to impose restrictions on the transaction. Prior research finds that on average, buybacks are beneficial to equity holders, both in the short run and the long run, yet these studies often overlook other stakeholders. More importantly, by focusing on the average financially healthy firms these tests are weak

when searching for potential harm. One notable exception: Chen and Wang (2012) find that buybacks made by financially constrained firms are followed by negative long-term abnormal returns and explain this by managerial overconfidence. In this paper we focus on the consequences of buybacks in another subsample: financially distressed firms. As in the case of financially constrained firms, repurchasing shares when you appear to be financially distressed seems like another example where buybacks could cause harm. However, we find no evidence of underinvestment, diminished innovation, or adverse effects on any stakeholder, including shareholders. Indeed, shareholders experience positive long-term excess returns, suggesting that when markets overestimate financial distress it creates an opportunity to buy back undervalued stock. Our findings provide no motivation for regulatory intervention.

Described Patents and Knowledge Diffusion between Firms, with S. Katie Moon and Paula Suh

Presented at: FMA Asia/Pacific (2025), AsianFA (2026)*.*

Surprisingly, only 7% of widely used front-page patent citations are explicitly described in the patent text (described patents), and 54% in-text described patents are not listed as citations on the front page of patents. Based on in-text described patents, we propose a new measure that captures firms' reliance on, as well as their intentions to acquire, key knowledge from other firms. Our measure of described patents is superior in embodying the true technology-based knowledge flows, as evidenced by citing firms' subsequent hiring of inventors. The widely used front-page patent citations are a noisier measure of knowledge flow due to selection biases introduced by patent lawyers and litigation liabilities. We consistently find that inventors who receive more in-text citations, particularly those described in a positive tone, are more likely to be hired by the citing firm. However, this prediction is significantly weaker using front-page citations. Furthermore, we find that trade secret protection through the Inevitable Disclosure Doctrine (IDD) affects the movement of inventors cited in the patent texts but not those cited on the front page.

Work in progress

Who Speaks What: Business TV Appearances, Visual Sentiment, and Asset Prices, with Diego García

We study how televised appearances by key market participants (CEOs, institutional investors, and sell-side analysts) on major U.S. business networks (CNBC, Bloomberg, Fox Business) affect asset prices and trading activity. We build a dataset from full-length broadcasts that combines sentence-level speaker attribution with multimodal sentiment from text, audio, and video. Using this pipeline, we test how the identity, tone, and visibility of different speakers transmit information to financial markets.

AI and Financial Education, with Byoung-Hyoun Hwang, Dongwoo Noh, and Sean Shin

Teaching Experience

Instructor, University of Colorado Boulder

- FNCE 3030: Investment and Portfolio Management (Undergraduate Core) — Spring 2023
  - 4 Sections (143 enrolled), Overall Instructor Rating: 4.7/5

Teaching Assistant, University of Colorado Boulder

- MSBX 6290: Textual Analysis in Business (MBA Elective) — Spring 2022
- FNCE 3030: Investment and Portfolio Management (Undergraduate Core) — Spring 2022

Student Mentorship, University of Colorado Boulder

- FNCE 4040: Financial Derivatives (Undergraduate Core) — Fall 2022
- MSBC 5031: Quantitative Methods (MBA Core) — Fall 2023

Industry Experience

Jiangsu HopeRun Fintech Company · *Model Analyst* — 2018-2019

Fellowships, Awards and Honors

- 2020 & 2022: *Recipient*, Gerald Hart Doctoral Research Summer Fellowship
- 2019 – 2025: *Recipient*, Full scholarship, Leeds Business School PhD scholarship
- 2014: National Training Program of Innovation for Undergraduates — "Commodity Future Trading Strategy Based on Changes of Net Positions", *completed with highest distinction*

Skills

- AI Agents
- Programming & Data Analysis: R, Python, Stata, SAS, MATLAB
- NLP Methods
- High-Performance Computing: Proficient in using research computing clusters

References

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